

How do peers and TV influence development?



T/Th 9:35-10:25am

Professor Casey Lew-Williams

Kennedy Casey, Abby Fergus, Sarah Joo, Chantal Valdivia, Claire Whiting

Media/art project presentations

Today & tomorrow during your precept.

Enjoy!!!



WHO DUN IT??

BABY EDITION

3 bullet points - due today/tomorrow!

- submit 3 bullet points on the 3 findings you found the most interesting/memorable from this course
- due on Canvas before your precept
- please remember them

FOREVER

Journal article + Final exam

- Journal article: **due on Monday December 8 by 11:59pm** (on Canvas). You may not touch AI. If we think any content is AI-related, we will report it to the ODUS Committee on Discipline.
- Final exam: **4:00-5:30pm on Monday, December 15 in our usual room (McCosh 50)**. Those of you with ODS approval for extended time will take the exam in Peretsman Scully Hall. We'll be in touch.
 - Non-cumulative, beginning with the first lecture on language
 - Same format as the midterm, same number of questions. You'll have much more time to complete it compared to the midterm.
 - Preceptors will hold extended office hours next week
 - Important note: sharing any exam content with a peer — this year or in the future — is a violation of the Honor Code. Pause and ask yourself if it's worth it.

Two lectures today:

1. The pervasive problem of bullying
2. The pervasive problem of screen time

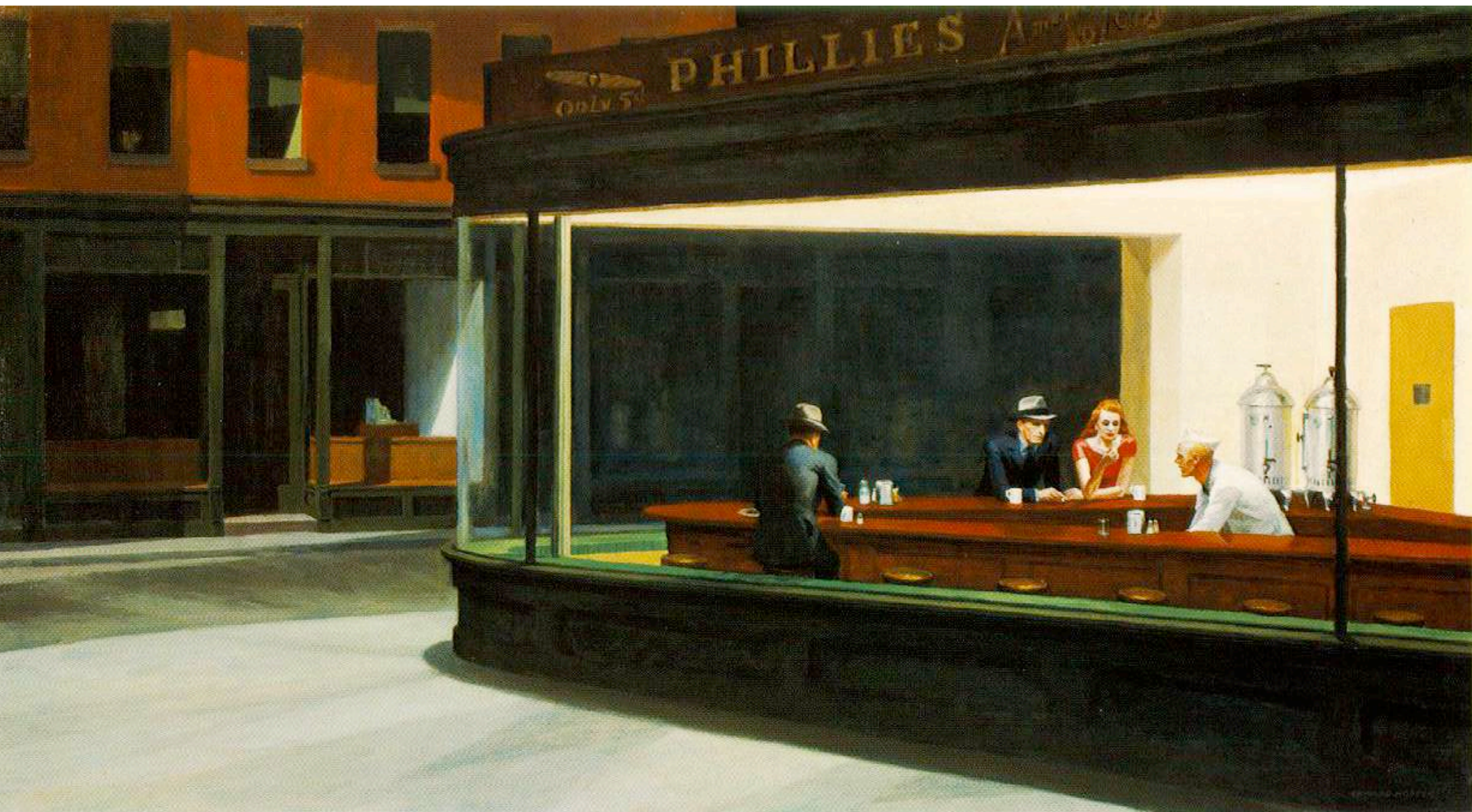
You

Think about the 2 people who are important to you. Are they friends, family, romantic partner?

Think about the last really important thing you told someone. Who did you tell it to first?

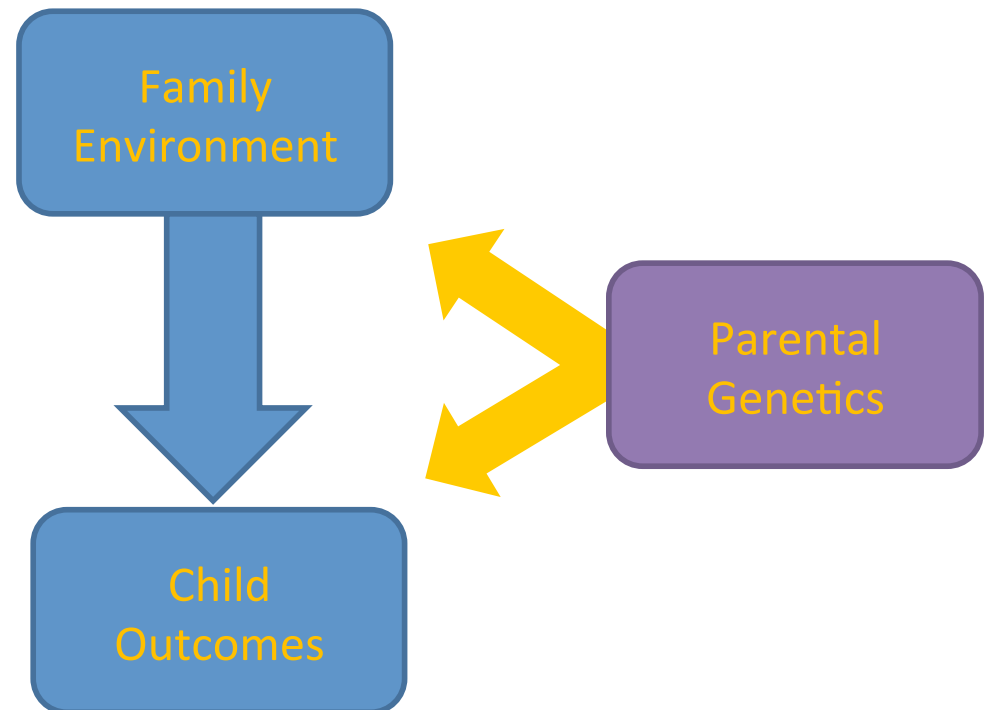
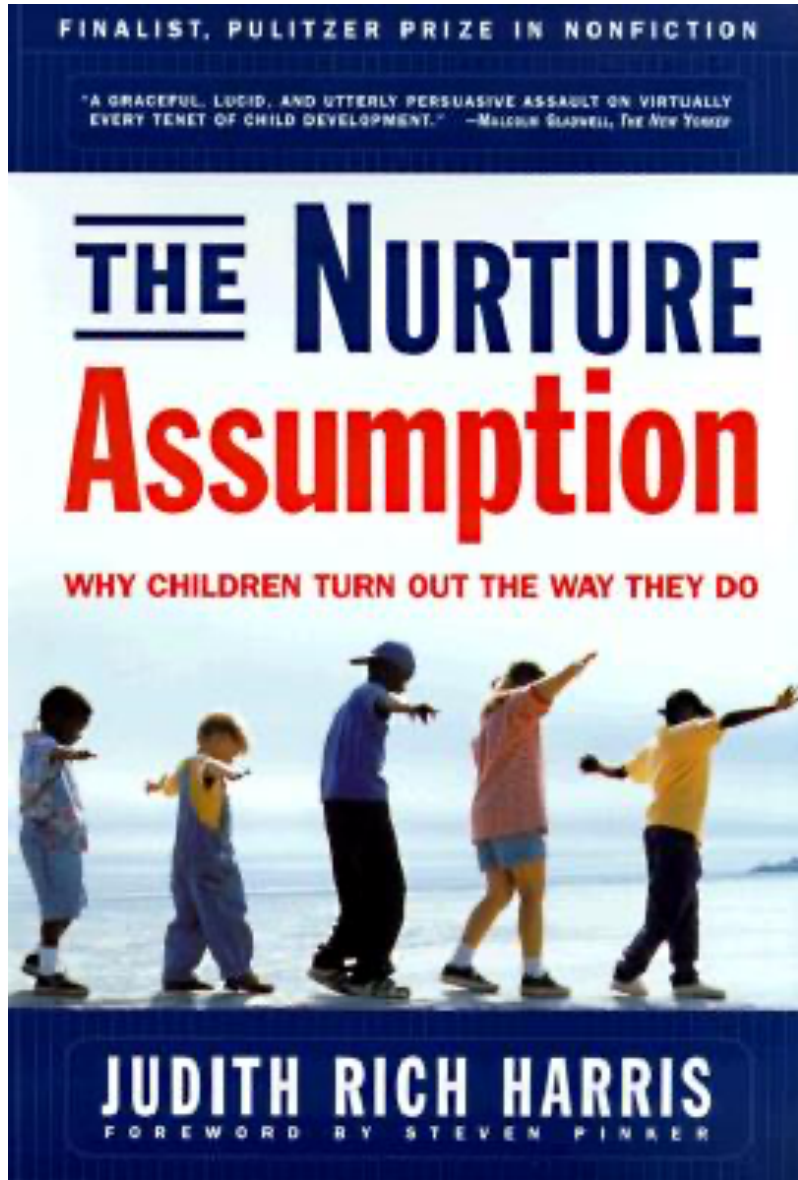
When's the last time you needed advice? Who did you go to first?



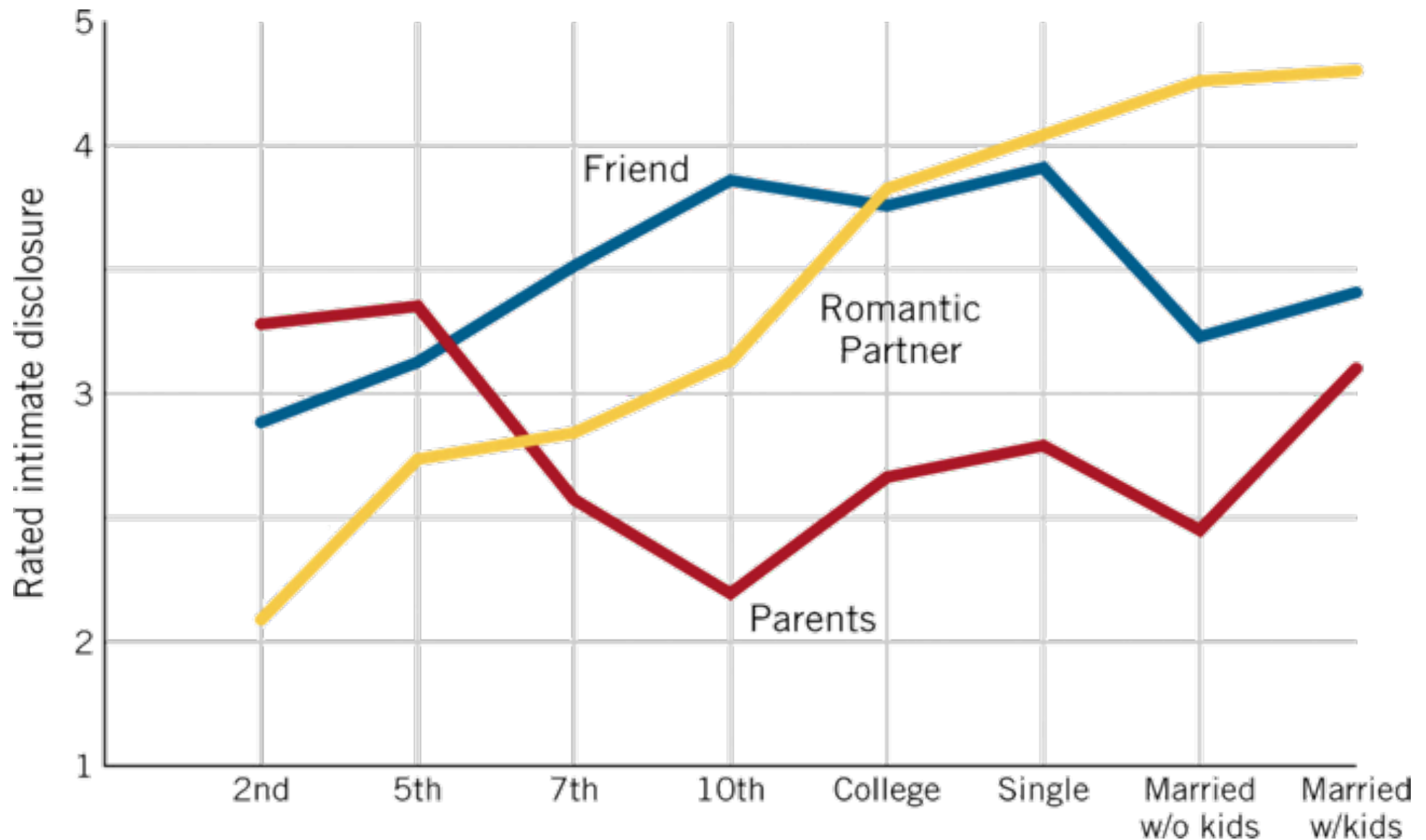




What if parents didn't matter?



What's special about peer relationships?



GPT romance

“You’re looking good today. Want snacks?”

“You look like Jesus if he were a butler in a Russian mansion”

“Your eyes are like two rainbows and a rainbow of eyes”

“Wait, this beanie hat, is it fashionable?”

“You look like a thing and I love you”

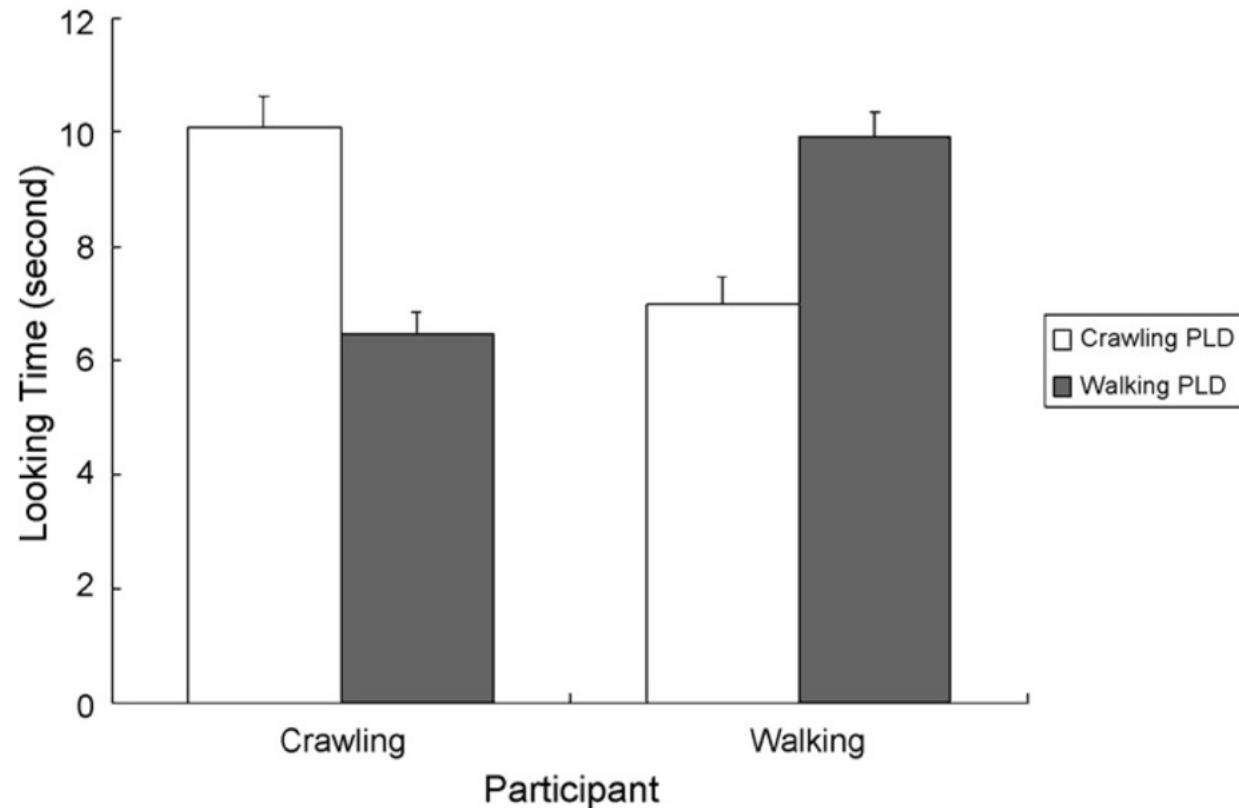
“I don’t care if you’re a doggo in a trenchcoat”

GPT-3: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2005.14165>

[https://www.vice.com/en/article/z3vjey/artificial-intelligence-ai-pickup-lines?
fbclid=IwAR3BKUpJHgWq8huQJjiqZGuVY_6WdeWmMgqlqLal0DGdBVZMaq-OuahqkfY](https://www.vice.com/en/article/z3vjey/artificial-intelligence-ai-pickup-lines?fbclid=IwAR3BKUpJHgWq8huQJjiqZGuVY_6WdeWmMgqlqLal0DGdBVZMaq-OuahqkfY)

Age as a social distinction

- Babies smile more at unfamiliar *children* than unfamiliar adults.
- Babies prefer to look at faces of same-age babies (vs. another age)
- Babies from 8-12 months prefer to look at point-light movies of babies who move like they do.



What's special about peer relationships?

same age, same status



space to negotiate identity

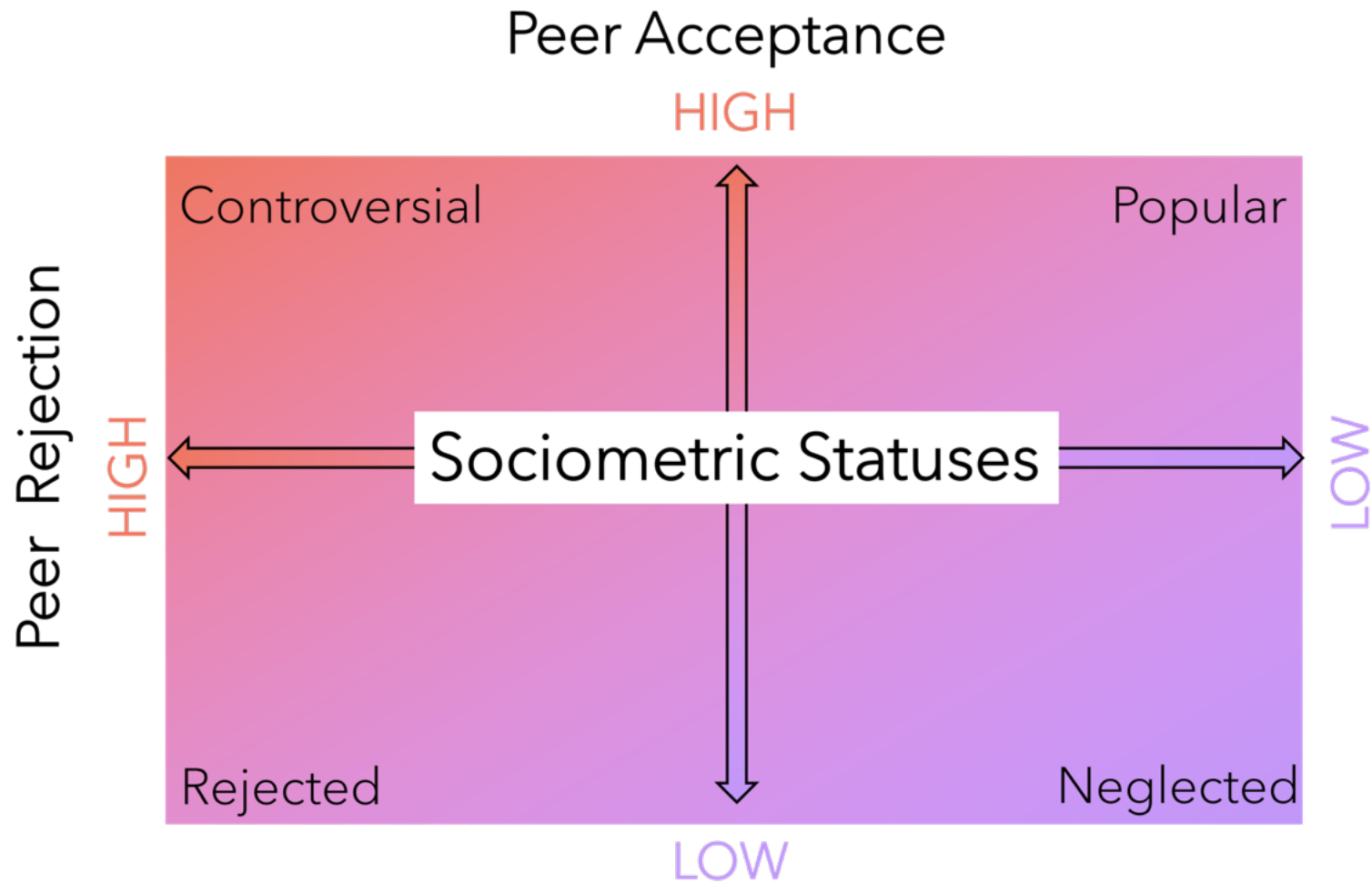
a more negotiated form of intimacy

Peer influences



Peer acceptance

Categories of peer acceptance, based on sociometric ratings:



What factors shape peer acceptance?

- Physical features: e.g., faces that fulfill some stereotype of attractiveness

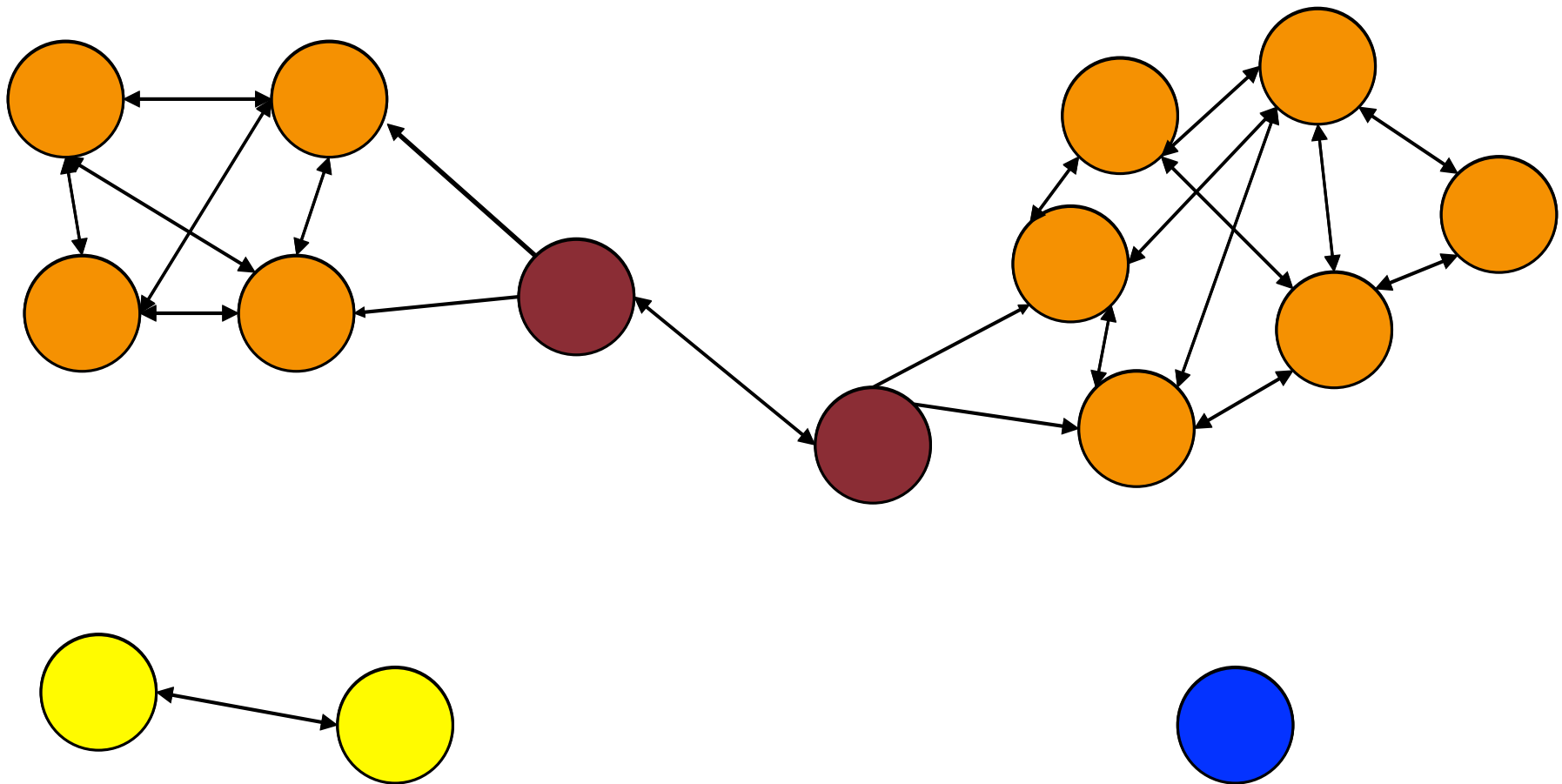


- Cognitive skills: language; the ability to read intentions
- Social skills: aggression; generosity

Peer relationships in adolescence

Cliques: groups of 2-12 individuals (average is 5-6)

Often same age and sex
Share common activities



Peer relationships in adolescence

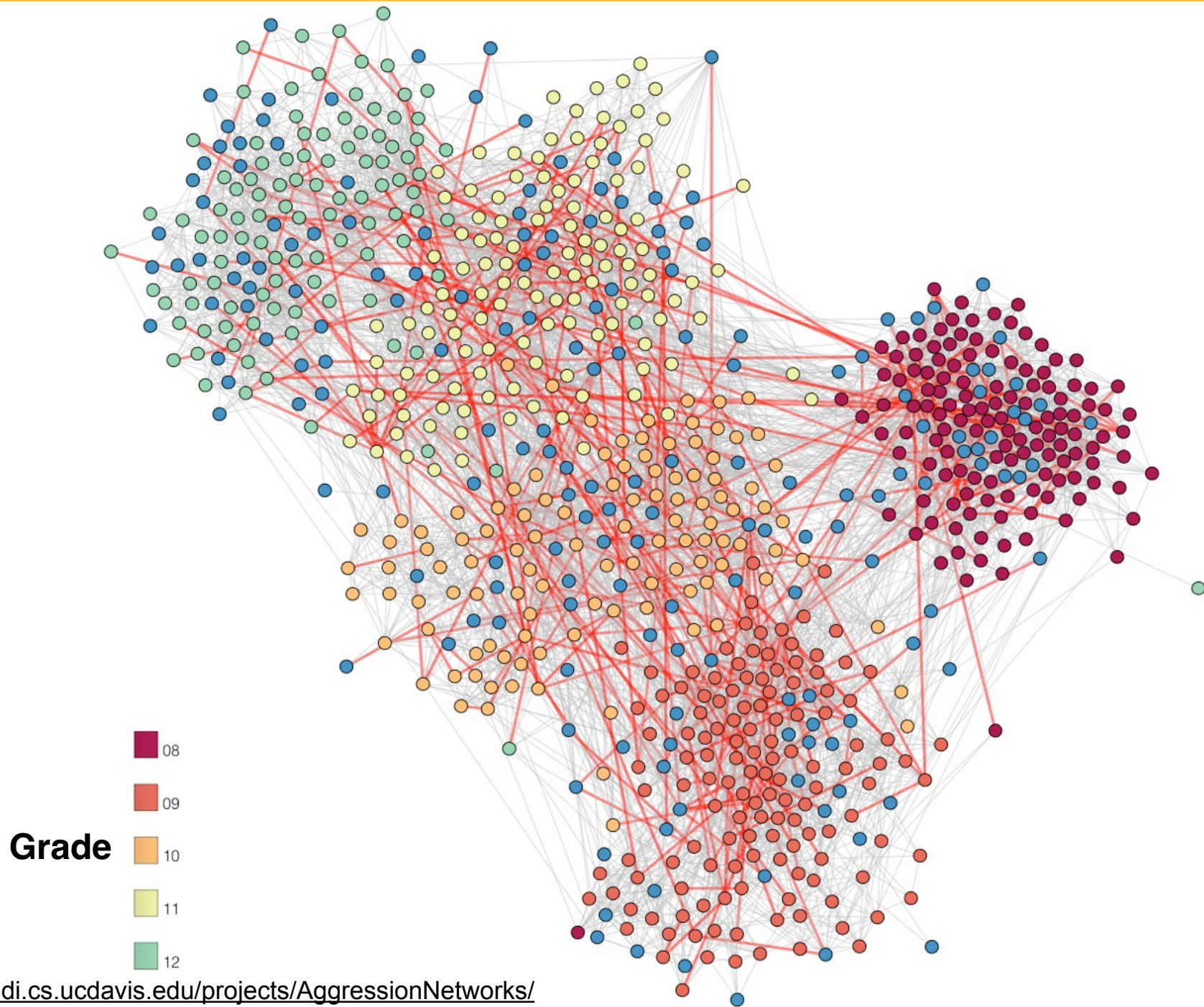
Crowds: large reputation-based or image-based groups

Jocks
Nerds
Preppies
Stoners
Punks
Skaters
Goths
AP kids
Band nerds
Drama crowd
Debate kids
Race/ethnicity-based groups
LGBTQ+ based groups
Christians
Loners
Rich kids
Yearbook/newspaper kids



Art kids
Gamers
Anime kids
Tech kids
Quiet kids
Ag kids

Visualization of friendship and aggression networks: Bully/victim links



Forms of peer aggression



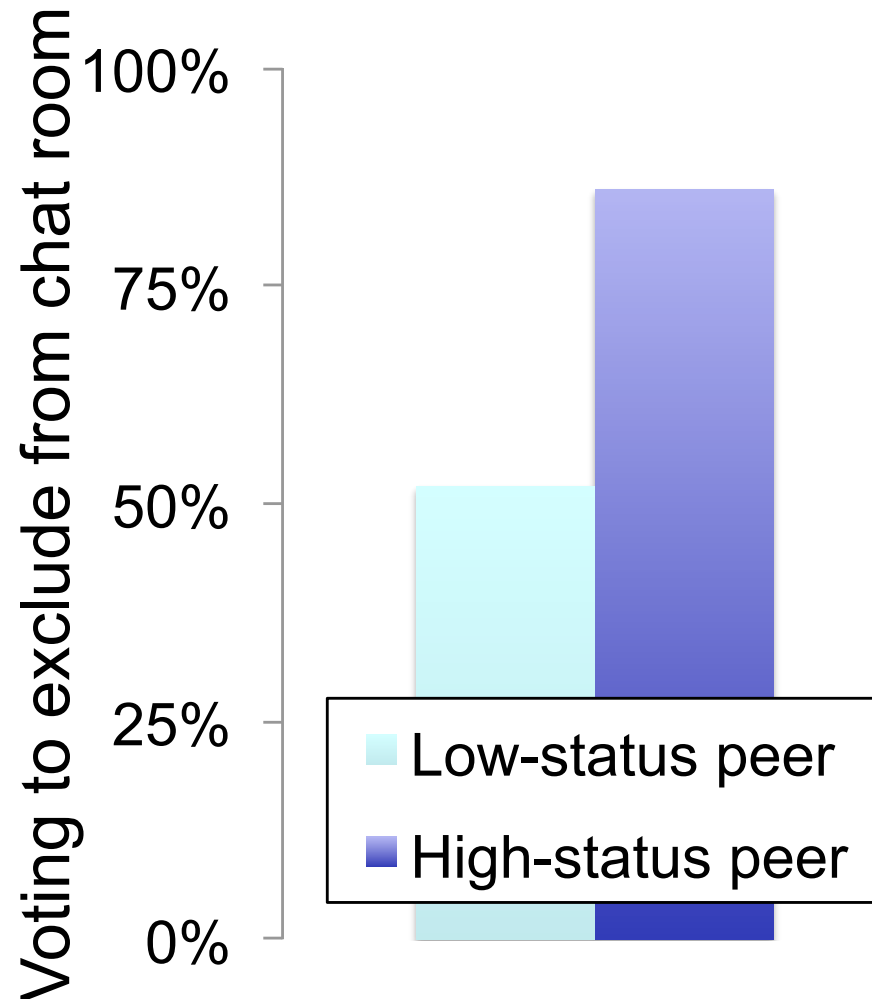
- **Physical:** hit, slap, push
- **Verbal:** insults, names
- **Indirect or relational:** gossip, exclusion, isolation
- **Bullying:** repeated peer aggression from high power person to low power person

Bullies and Victims

- Bullies often target perceived 'differences', vulnerable individuals, or lower-status peers.
 - Gender non-conforming peers
 - People from minoritized groups
 - People with developmental disabilities
 - Young women
 - Recently arrived migrant youth
 - Less popular kids
- Bullies usually have more power than the victim.
- Bullies can be persistent over time. Or it can be a hit-and-run.
- Bullies are twice as likely to later engage in criminal behavior.

Peer influence in adolescence

- High school students joined a chat room, and were randomly assigned to chat with high- vs. low-status peer
- The peer then excludes a 3rd person from joining them.
- Does the participant go along with this exclusion?



Effects of bullying

- Bullying works by messing with the victim's sense of self.
- Also by creating a sense of isolation, and destroying trust.
- Bullying vs. mobbing
 - Mobbing is when a group repeatedly harasses or excludes someone. There is a cumulative effect of this treatment from multiple/many people.
 - People can sometimes be involved in bullying/mobbing without thinking about it. And they will deny being bullies.

Effects of bullying

psychological

- Anxiety, depression
- Shame, isolation
- Lower self-esteem
- Difficulty trusting others
- Risk of self-harm and suicidal ideation

academic

- Worse grades
- Worse concentration
- Social/educational avoidance

physical

- Sleep problems
- Stomachaches
- Changes in appetite



TWO BOYS, TWO TOWNS, TWO TRAGEDIES

BULLIED TO DEATH?



CARL WALKER-HOOVER, 11

JAHEEM HERRERA, 11

IN 10 DAYS, TWO BOYS HANGED THEMSELVES AFTER BEING TEASED AT SCHOOL. COULD THEY HAVE BEEN SAVED?

The first child, Carl Walker-Hoover, came home from school on April 6, sat with his mother for a while, then waited in his room while she made him a cheeseburger. "I called up to him while it was cooking," says Sirdener Walker, 44. "He didn't answer. So I went upstairs." There, she found Carl, 11, hanging from an electric cord along over a banister. "I couldn't hold him up," she says. "His weight was so heavy. All I could do was scream."

Ten days later, the second boy, Jaheem Herrera, came home from

school with his report card. "He had all A's and B's," says his mother, Masi-ka Bermudez, 29. "I gave him a high five." Jaheem, 11, went to his room, and when dinner was ready, "I kept calling him but he didn't answer," says Bermudez. "My daughter and I went upstairs. We unlocked the door. We walked in, and I saw him hanging in the closet. I tried to hold him up. When I touched him, he was cold."

An unthinkable scene played out twice just 10 days apart—how could it be? Why did Carl, a bright, creative kid from Springfield, Mass., who

wrote plays and once made his own currency, and Jaheem, of Decatur, Ga., who loved drawing flowers and doing funny dances, decide to end their lives? Their mothers say the tragedies have something in common: Both Carl and Jaheem were teased and called gay by bullies. "How could his school have let it reach the point where a child kills himself?" says Bermudez. "Parents are at work thinking their kids are safe, but they're not."

Bullying is hardly a new problem, and in recent years schools have been addressing it, experts say. Still,

People

TEEN SUICIDE TRAGEDIES

DEADLY BULLYING

At least three teens, tormented by classmates, have taken their own lives in the past month. Why did this happen, and how can it be stopped?

UTAH'S FRESHMAN
TYLER CLEMENTE, 18

TARGET
SETH WALSH, 13

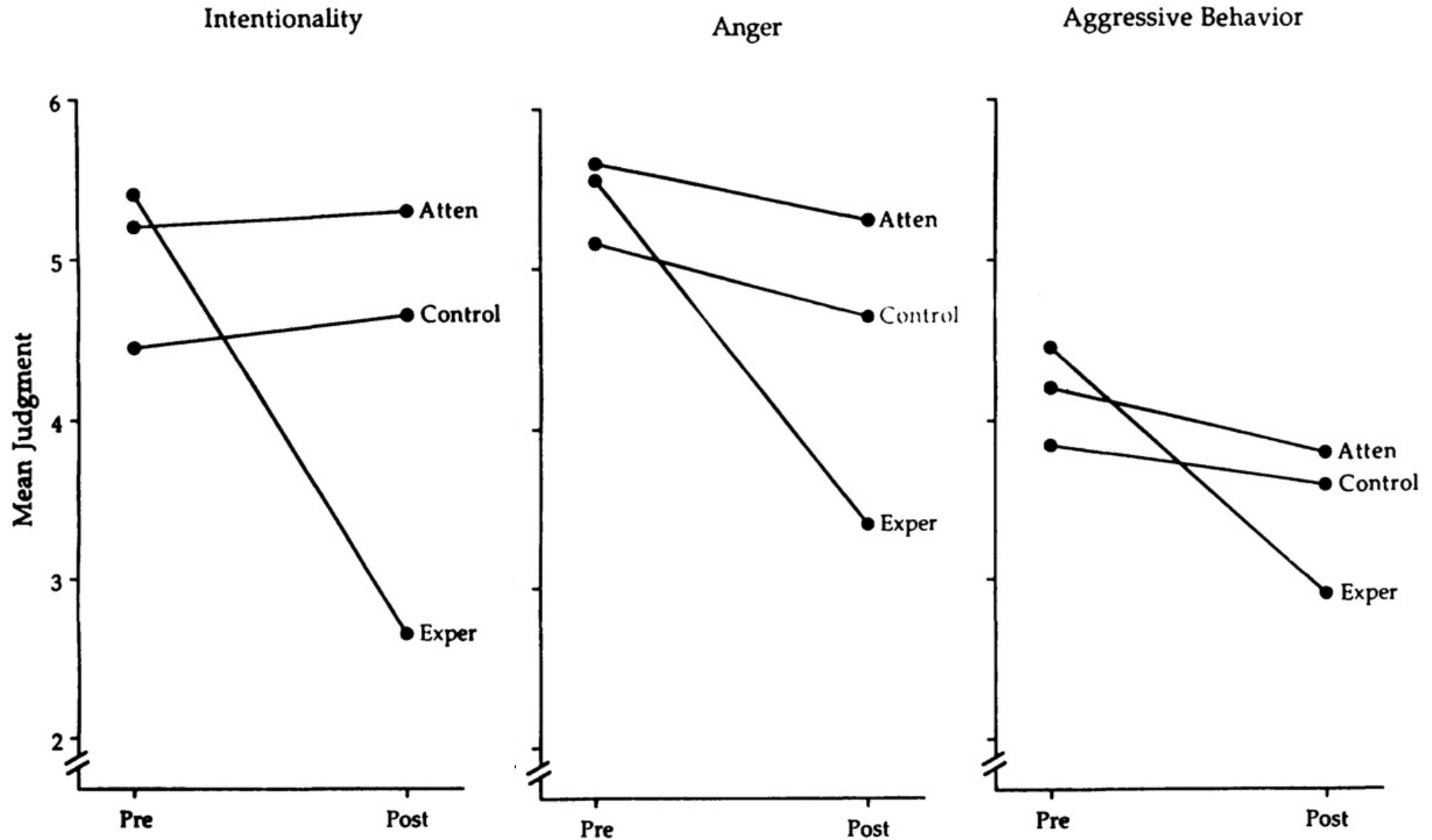
TARGET
ASHER BROWN, 13

OKSANA GRIGORIEVA

Anti-bullying interventions

- People have tried many approaches to intervention
- Generally low effect sizes 😞 (according to a meta-analysis)
- Interventions tend to influence attitudes, knowledge, and self-perceptions, but not actual bullying behaviors.

Hostile attribution bias interventions



Using social networks to change school norms

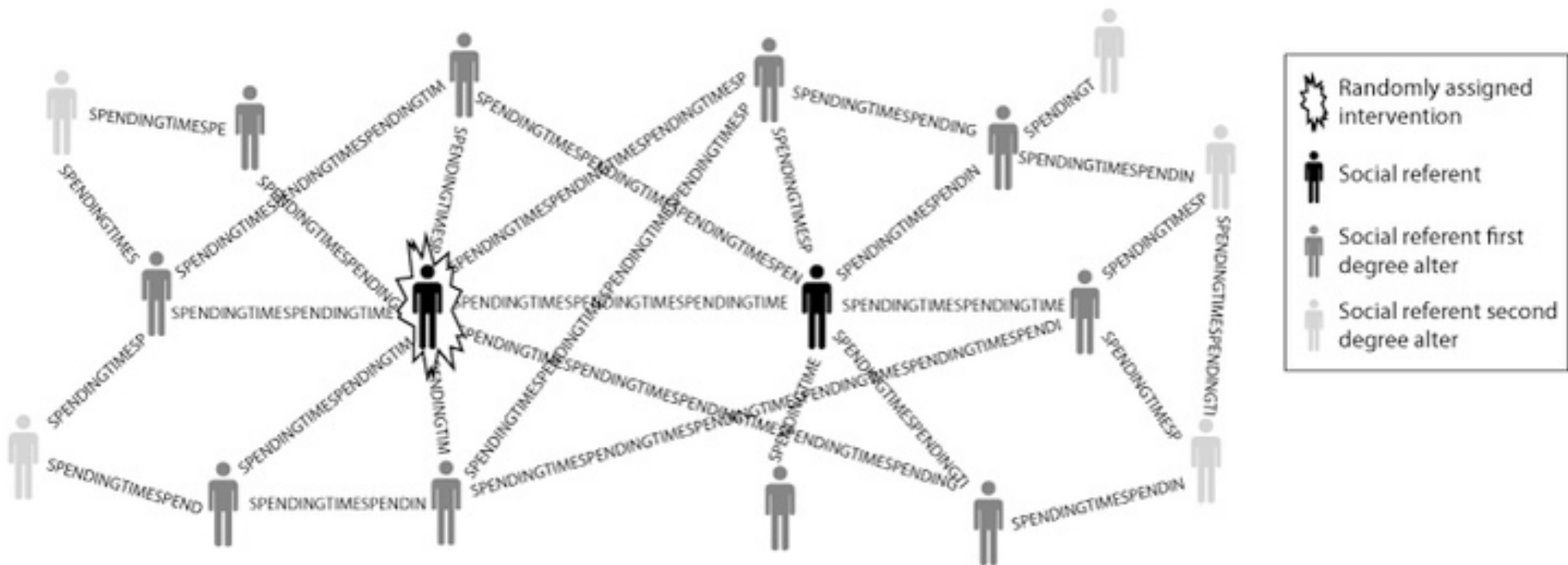
Premise of the intervention:

People pay attention to other people to understand social norms, & they adjust their behaviors in response. Let's work with this to reduce bullying.



Using social networks to reduce harassment in schools

- Social network surveys in public high schools determined which individuals were the most 'connected'
- Changing the behavior of a 'connected' individual spreads to others, and changes peers' perceptions of school norms and harassment behavior.





End The Hate...
Change The Culture

Stand for the Silent



BULLYING
RECOVERY
RESOURCE CENTER

NJ Anti-Bullying Task Force

NJ Coalition for Bullying Awareness and Prevention

Who is a good “leader”?

- Somebody who draws on their strengths to do good?
- Somebody who’s good at telling others what to do? Good at stuffing their resume with mini-accomplishments?
- Somebody who can effectively collaborate with others and guide group progress toward a goal?
- Somebody quiet, sitting there in the corner, who has amazing raw horsepower?
- Example finding: Kid leaders are (on average) more narcissistic, and are not necessarily good at leading. They just convince others they are.





The pervasive problem of screen time

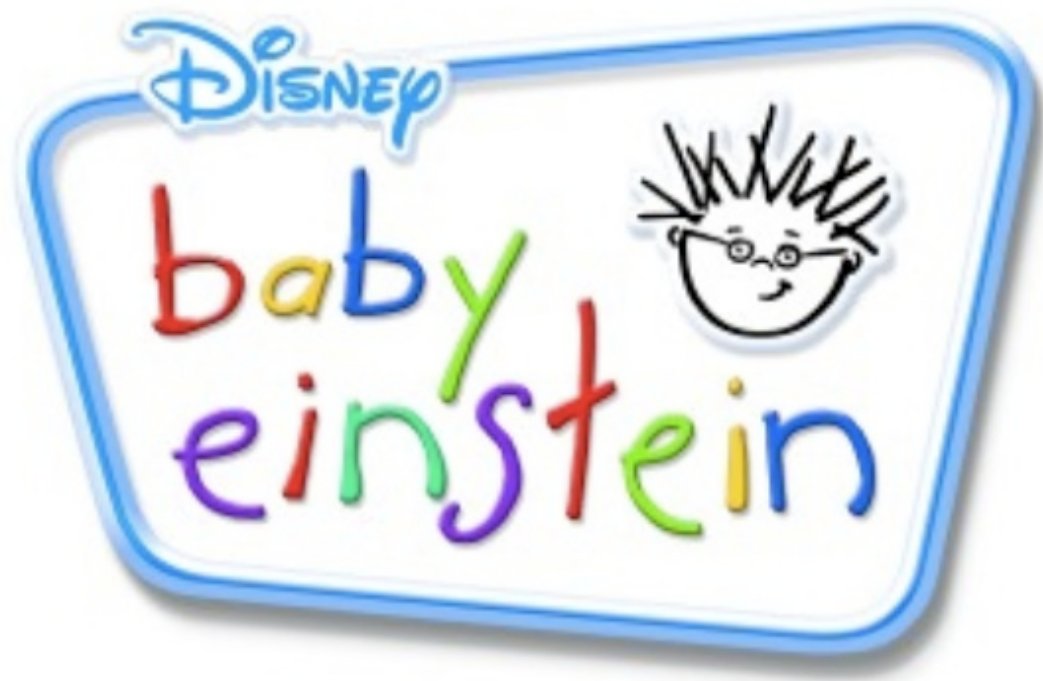
A man was caught watching the real world.

29,450 points · 312 comments





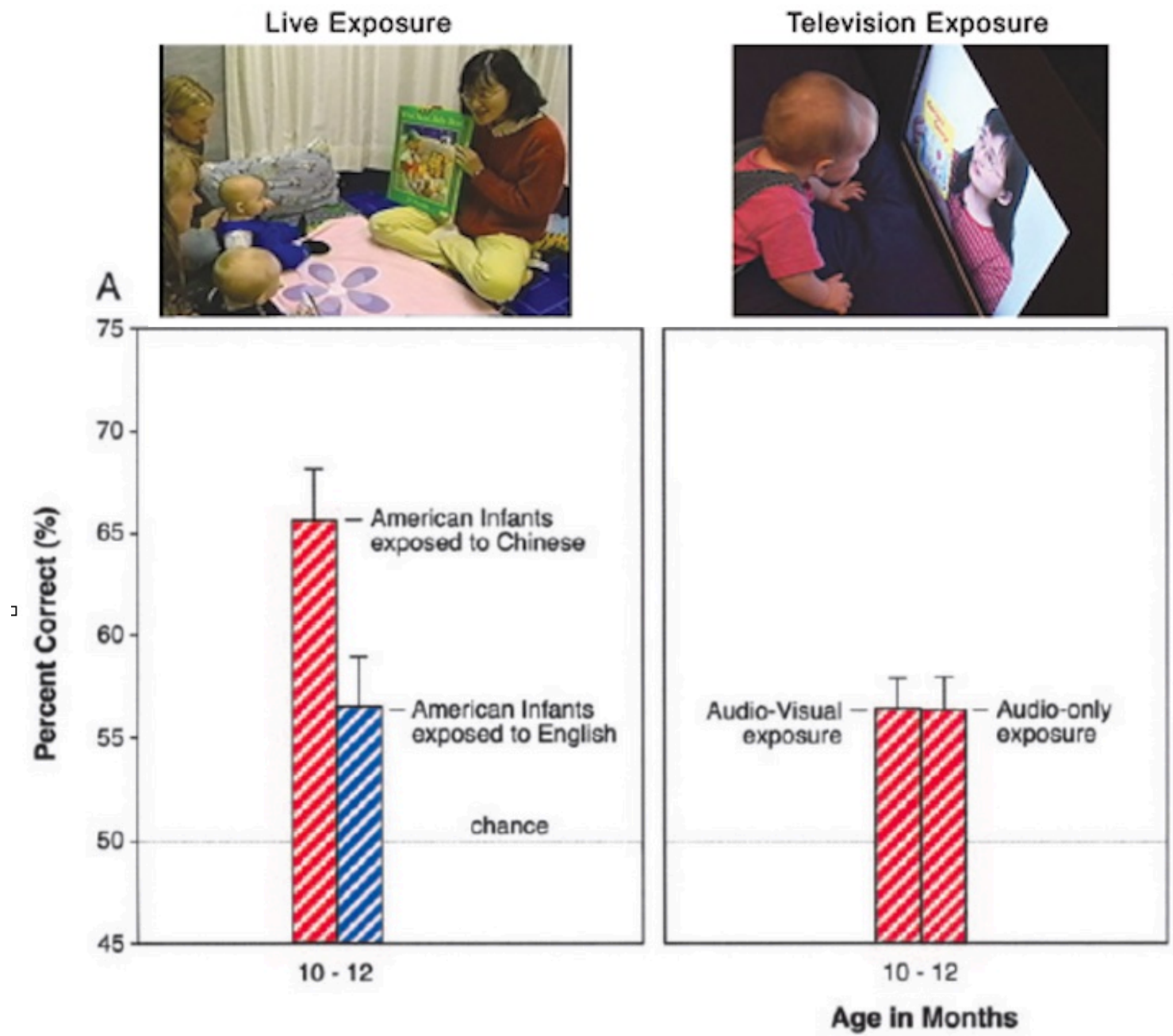
It starts early...



Screen use today

- 50% of kids under age 2 watch TV every day
- Of children who consume screen media: average of 2 hours per day
- 97% of U.S. kids under the age of 4 use mobile devices, regardless of family income
- 72% of children under age 8 use mobile devices for playing games, watching videos, and using apps.
- Many teenagers use their phones for 7+ hours per day, with nearly constant use of the internet.

Learning speech sounds from live interaction vs. screens

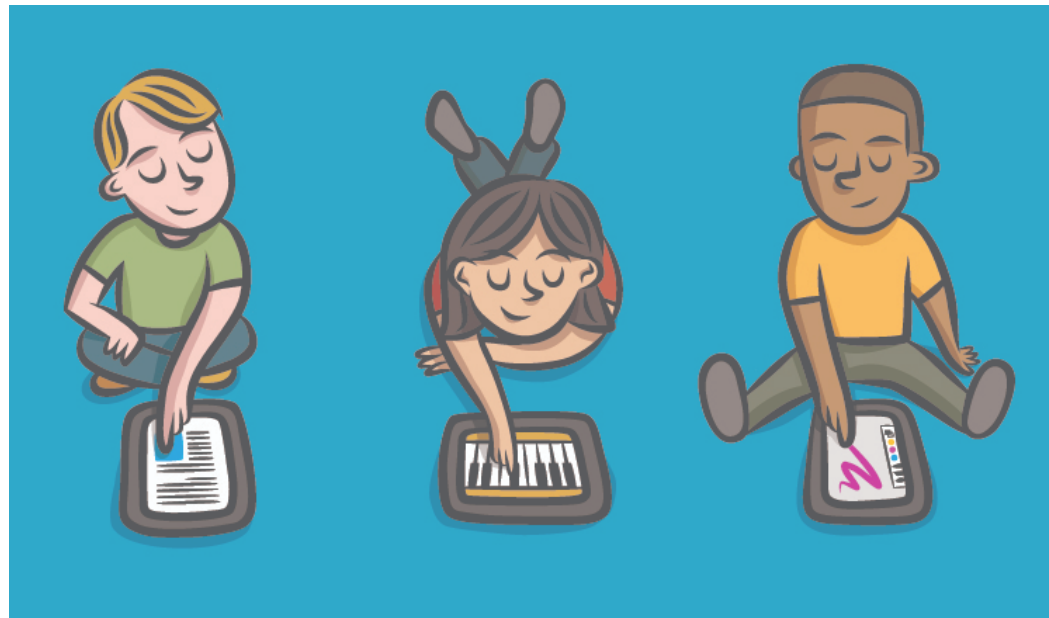


(Kuhl, Tsao, & Liu, 2003)

Screen time recs from the American Academy of Pediatrics

- For children younger than 18 months, avoid use of screen media other than video-chatting. Parents of children 18 to 24 months of age who want to introduce digital media should choose high-quality programming, and watch it with their children to help them understand what they're seeing.
- For children ages 2 to 5 years, limit screen use to 1 hour per day of high-quality programs. Parents should co-view media with children to help them understand what they are seeing and apply it to the world around them.
- For children ages 6 and older, place consistent limits on the time spent using media, and the types of media, and make sure media does not take the place of adequate sleep, physical activity and other behaviors essential to health.
- Designate media-free times together, such as dinner or driving, as well as media-free locations at home, such as bedrooms.
- Have ongoing communication about online citizenship and safety, including treating others with respect online and offline.

“Our meta-analysis results suggest that, on average, **...children scored approximately half a standard deviation...higher on tests of learning when they were taught the information face-to-face** rather than watching the same information given on video.”



Effects on children's word learning

- **Question:** Is media viewing associated with language development in children under age 2?

Each average hour
of viewing baby media per day
is associated with a 17-word decrement
in vocabulary **at 16 months**

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Is E-Reading to Your Toddler Story Time, or Simply Screen Time?

By DOUGLAS QUENQUA OCT. 11, 2014

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Clifford the Big Red Dog looks fabulous on an iPad. He sounds good, too — tap the screen and hear him pant as a blue truck roars into the frame. “Go, truck, go!” cheers the narrator.

But does this count as story time? Or is it just screen time for babies?

It is a question that parents, pediatricians and researchers are struggling to answer as children’s books, just like all the other ones, migrate to digital media.



The American Academy of Pediatrics advises against screen time for toddlers; however, story time is now often on a tablet.

Jessica Kourkounis for The New York Times

Disruption to play-based behaviors

- **Question:** How does background TV affect (1) children's behaviors, and (2) parent-child interactions?



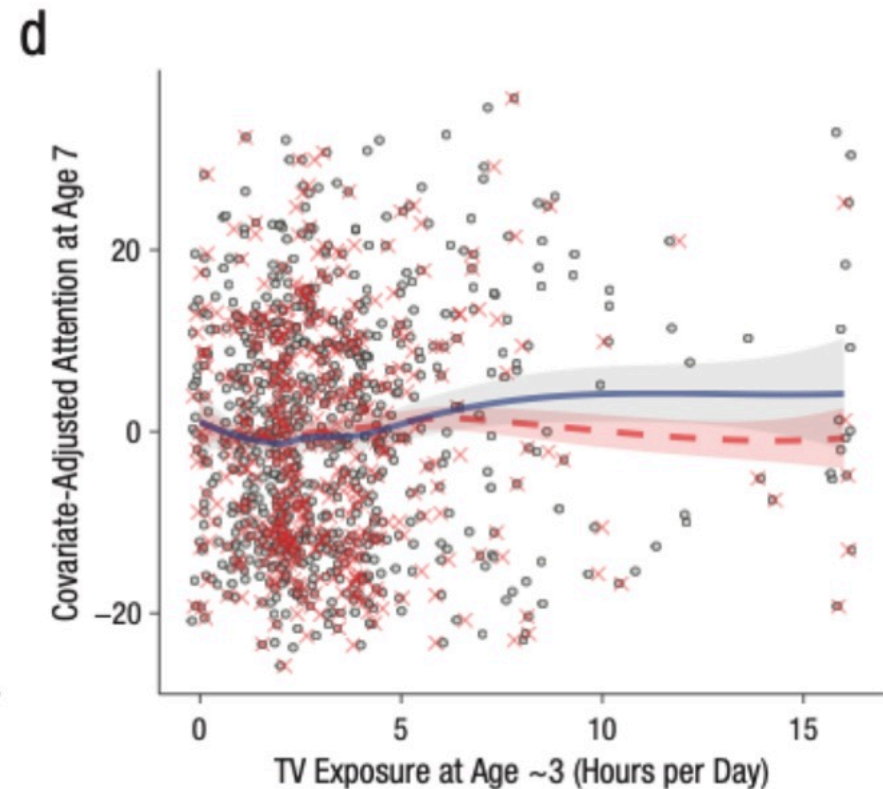
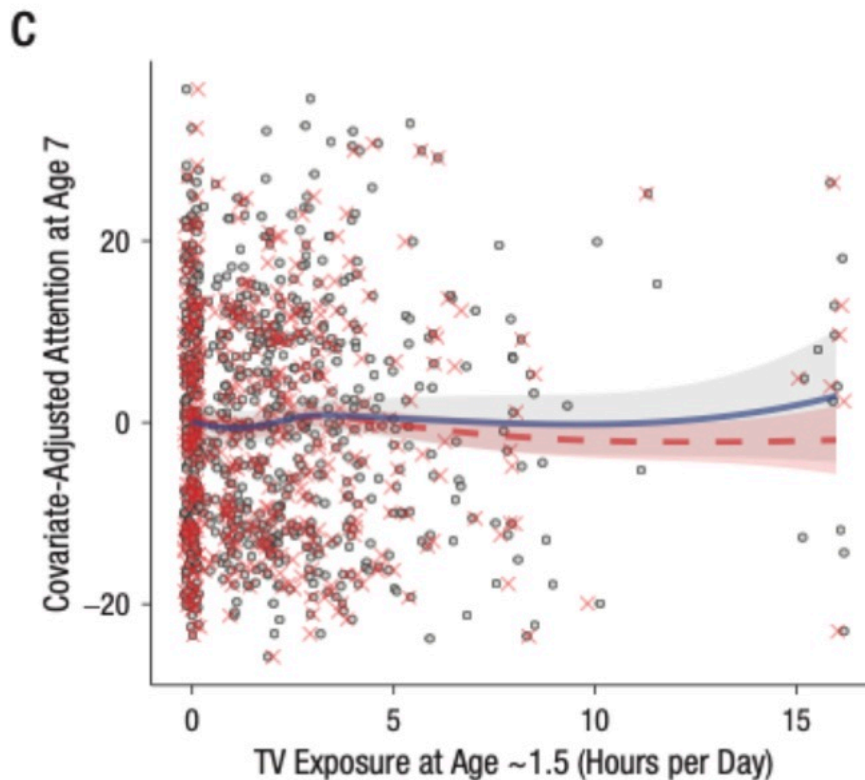
Disruption to play-based behaviors

- **Question:** What kinds of toys are associated with high-quality parent-infant communication?



Disruption to attention abilities?

- **Question:** Does early exposure to TV cause attentional problems?
(answer: maybe not)



Disruption to attention abilities?

- **Question:** Does exposure to fast-paced fantasy shows (like *SpongeBob*) affect attention and executive function? (yes, in the short term)



Learning behaviors from media

- **Question:** Does watching TV encourage aggressive behavior? Prosocial behavior?



How can we design digital media to support early learning?

Screen-Based Pedagogical Supports

Type of support	Example
Ostensive cues	
Definitions	"A <i>subway</i> is an underground train." (Bubble Guppies)
Repetition	"Planet nine is <i>Pluto</i> . But, I don't see Pluto anywhere. Girl: That's because it's the Pluto is very hard to find. Boy: Uhoh! Pluto is hiding! Boy: Yes, there he is! Pluto, it's time to go back where you belong. (Little Einstein)
Features of target words	" <i>Otters</i> have webbed feet that help them swim (Otter demonstrates). "They use the paddles." (Go Diego Go)
Examples	"A <i>career</i> is a job that you train for that you expect to have for a long time. That's a teacher, or a scientist." (Sesame Street)
Attention-directing cues	
Visual effect	"Wow! A <i>volcano</i> (picture appears) (Aquaphonics adventure)
Sound effect	"Is this box shaped like a <i>square</i> ?" [digital clicking sound effect] "Right! The big square box!" (Dora the Explorer)
Humor	Princess: This must be the <i>jungle</i> . It's on the other side of this . . . this . . . Girl: Quicksand (Around the World Adventure)
Guess/pause	A: "How about a piece of fruit?" B: "Hmmm . . . a piece of fruit would be great! Which of these is a piece of fruit? [pause] (Blue's Clues)

Take-home messages about screens & young kids

- Interactive media > passive media
- Co-interaction with people = great
- Screen time is okay in moderation! Don't feel too guilty. Don't ban, but *limit* screen time.
- See the content yourself to determine if it's in line with your mindset.
- Think about non-sedentary alternatives
- **Don't let screens replace too much of children's enjoyable playtime. Nothing can replace the fun of sitting on the ground and doing something together.**

